

# Jyot Antani, PhD

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**Research Interests:** Biophysics, Imaging Technology, Virology, Host-pathogen Interactions

**Special Skills:** MATLAB, Image Analysis - Biomatter Tracking, CAD Modeling, Microscopy

## Experience & Education

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| Jun 2021-<br>Now      | Postdoctoral Research Associate, Yale University (US)<br><a href="#">Paul Turner Lab</a> , Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology<br><a href="#">Thierry Emonet Lab</a> , Molecular, Cellular and Developmental Biology<br>Research: Biophysics of interactions between bacteriophage and bacteria |
| Aug 2016-<br>May 2021 | PhD, <a href="#">Pushkar Lele Lab</a> , Department of Chemical Engineering, Texas A&M University (US)<br>Dissertation title: Sensory Functions of the Bacterial Flagellar Motor                                                                                                                            |
| Jul 2012-<br>May 2016 | Bachelor of Technology with Honours in Chemical Engineering<br>Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay), Mumbai (India)                                                                                                                                                                          |

## Publications

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- [Antani JD](#), Gupta R, Lee AH, Rhee KY, Manson MD, Lele PP (2021) Mechanosensitive recruitment of stator units promotes binding of the response regulator CheY-P to the flagellar motor. *Nature Communications*. doi: [10.1038/s41467-021-25774-2](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-021-25774-2)
- [Antani JD](#), Sumali AX, Lele TP, Lele PP (2021) Asymmetric random walks reveal that the chemotaxis network modulates flagellar rotational bias in *Helicobacter pylori*. *eLife*. doi:[10.7554/eLife.63936](https://doi.org/10.7554/eLife.63936)
- Katiyar A\*, [Antani JD](#)\*, McKee BP, Gupta R, Lele PP, Lele TP (2021) A method for direct imaging of x-z cross-sections of fluorescent samples. *Journal of Microscopy*. doi:[10.1111/jmi.12965](https://doi.org/10.1111/jmi.12965) (\*equal contribution)
- Wong GCL, [Antani JD](#), et al. (2021) Roadmap on emerging concepts in the physical biology of bacterial biofilms: from surface sensing to community formation. *Physical Biology*. doi:[10.1088/1478-3975/abdc0e](https://doi.org/10.1088/1478-3975/abdc0e)
- Ford KM, [Antani JD](#), Nagarajan A, Johnson MM, Lele PP (2018) Switching and torque generation in swarming cells of *E. coli*. *Frontiers in Microbiology*, 9, 2197. doi:[10.3389/fmicb.2018.02197](https://doi.org/10.3389/fmicb.2018.02197)
- [Antani JD](#), Gupta R, Lele PP. The chemotaxis conundrum for a polar-flagellated bacterium. *In preparation*.
- Katiyar A, Zhang J, [Antani JD](#), Yu Y, Lele PP, Reinhart-King CA, Sniadecki NJ, Roux KJ, Dickinson RB, Lele TP. Drop-like nuclear deformation facilitated by lamin A/C allows cells to move through obstacle. *In revision at Journal of Cell Biology*.

## Conference Presentations

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- [Antani JD](#), Lele PP. Modulation of chemotactic signaling in bacteria by mechanical forces.  
Mar 2019 | ChEGSA Annual Symposium, Texas A&M University, College Station (USA).  
Oct 2018 | American Institute of Chemical Engineers (AIChE) Annual Meeting, Pittsburgh (USA).  
Dec 2017 | Texas Branch of American Society for Microbiology, 2017 Fall Meeting, College Station (USA).
- [Antani JD](#), Lele PP. Asymmetric Swimming and Chemotaxis in *Helicobacter pylori*.  
Jan 2021 | Bacterial Locomotion And Signal Transduction (BLAST) XVI Meeting, Zoom (online).  
Feb 2020 | Biophysical Society (BPS) Annual Meeting, San Diego (USA).  
Jan 2019 | Bacterial Locomotion And Signal Transduction (BLAST) XV Meeting, New Orleans (USA).
- [Antani JD](#), Venkatesh KV. Analysis of Glucose Homeostasis in Humans.  
Nov 2015 | Futuristic Approach for Alternatives to Animal Testing [CEFIPRA](#) seminar, IIT Bombay, India.

## Technical Skills

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Bacterial Culturing    Perfusion & Thermal Control Experiments    Microscopy: Dark-field, Optical Tweezing,  
Molecular Biology    Prototyping & 3D-printing    TIRF, FRET, Image Analysis

## Computer Proficiency / Computational Skills

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Image Processing & Analysis: MATLAB, Python, ImageJ – {Highlight: particle-tracking algorithms}  
Design & Development: SolidWorks, AutoCAD, LabVIEW, Molecular Biology {SnapGene, Benchling}  
Simulation Packages: ANSYS Fluent, Aspen Plus, OpenFOAM, COMSOL, CHARMM, VMD  
Programming: MATLAB, Python, C, C++, Fortran, HTML

## Honors & Awards

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2020    CIRTIL Associate Certificate, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning  
2015    Best Poster Award, AMAT seminar, IIT Bombay  
2015    Undergraduate Research Award URA01, IIT Bombay  
2012    All India Rank 1427 in Joint Entrance Examination for engineering, among 479,651 participants  
2008    National Talent Search Scholarship, NCERT, India

## Doctoral Research

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### Molecular mechanisms of host substrate sensing by bacterial flagellar motors

Determined the effect of mechanical forces on chemotactic output of the bacterial flagellar motor, with phase microscopy, optical tweezers, and TIRF imaging. Developed a biophysical model for the regulation of allosteric interactions by mechanical force.

### Motility, chemotaxis, and random spread of *Helicobacter pylori*, the carcinogenic pathogen

Devised a technique to experimentally determine the chemotactic activity of *H. pylori*. Studied the biophysical principles governing chemotactic migration by this bacterial species which employs run-reversal motility – different from the traditionally studied *E. coli*.

### Design and development of experimental and analytical framework

Designing 3D-printed imaging chambers for specific requirements in microscopy experiments, e.g., perfusion, imaging side-views.  
Writing MATLAB-based image analysis codes for tracking motile bacteria, mammalian cell-nuclei, and fluorophores.

## Additional Research Experience

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Jul 2015-    Analysis of Glucose Homeostasis in Humans  
Feb 2016

**Guide: Prof. K. V. Venkatesh, IIT Bombay**

Formulated a Hill function-based empirical biochemical model of body glucose concentration following a fixed food-intake, obtained least-squares fits to data acquired from 150+ individuals. Constructed a classification tree based on fit-parameters using machine learning in MATLAB; established a statistical grouping among Diabetic and Healthy individuals.

May-Jul    A Novel Protocol for Coating Lipid Bilayers onto Silver Nanocubes  
2015

**Guide: Dr. Hung-Jen Wu, Texas A&M University**

Established a protocol to use a tip-sonicator for making small unilamellar vesicles of lipids, to coat lipid bilayers onto Silver nanocubes. Employed a Localized Surface Plasmon Resonance-based nanocube sensor to monitor protein binding on supported lipid bilayers. Analyzed binding kinetics of GM1 ganglioside with Cholera Toxin Subunit B.

May 2014-    Design of a Chemical Vapor Deposition Reactor  
Apr 2015

**Guide: Prof. Mahesh S. Tirumkudulu, IIT Bombay**

Simulated fluid flow around a disk, successfully obtained the pressure coefficients observed experimentally in literature. Proposed an unconventional design for uniform coating of parylene polymer onto silicon micro-wafers in a micro-scale Chemical Vapor Deposition reactor. Modeled Parylene flow using ANSYS Fluent, enhanced the proposed design.

Jun 2013    Process Improvement and Technology in Jaggery-Making

**Guide: Prof. Sanjay M. Mahajani, IIT Bombay**

Examined units under development for continuous production as well as recuperation in manufacturing Jaggery, the traditional non-centrifugal cane sugar. Analyzed Jaggery samples for acidity, moisture content, water activity, density, sugar content etc; observed the XRD and ESEM techniques.

## Teaching & Mentoring Experience

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- Fall 2019 | A hands-on workshop for image processing and single-particle tracking in MATLAB  
*Pushkar Lele Lab, Texas A&M University*
- Apr 2017-  
Apr 2018 | AggieE\_Challenge – Undergraduate Mentoring, Texas A&M University  
Graduate-mentor to a multidisciplinary team of eight undergraduate students employing 3D-printing technology to design scaled-up bacterial models, in order to study the hydrodynamic effects of cell morphology on motility.

### Teaching Assistant at Texas A&M Chemical Engineering

Heat Transfer Operations (Spring 2019)

Bioprocess Engineering (Spring 2017, Fall 2016)

## Teaching & Mentoring Training

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- Sep 2021-  
Dec 2021 | Auburn University Preparing Future Faculty Workshop  
Interactive workshops consisting panel discussions from faculty and university administrators
- Sep 2021 | [Fundamentals of Inclusive Teaching](#)  
*Poorvu Center: Graduate and Postdoctoral Teaching Development, Yale University*  
A 4-part workshop on creating a respectful, supportive, equitable, and transparent classroom environment
- Aug 2018-  
Dec 2019 | [Academy for Future Faculty \(AFF\)](#), Center for Teaching Excellence, Texas A&M University  
*Faculty Mentor: Dr. Micah Green, Texas A&M University*  
A program designed for training graduate students as future faculty members, featuring weekly seminars and workshops, and anchored by faculty mentorship
- Jul-  
Aug 2019 | An Introduction to Evidence-Based Undergraduate STEM Teaching  
*Multi-university Massive Open Online Course from the NSF-funded CIRTl network*  
Eight-week online course on [edX.org](#) catering introduction to effective teaching strategies and the research that supports them. Attended local learning community meetings for the course at Texas A&M University
- Oct 2019 | Improving Research Mentoring Relationships – Introduction to Effective Mentorship  
*Center for the Improvement of Mentored Experiences in Research (CIMER)*  
1-day workshop at Texas A&M University, conducted by CIMER from University of Wisconsin-Madison

## Leadership & Management

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- Jun 2021 | [People Management Skills](#) – Course, Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development, UK
- Oct 2018-  
Aug 2020 | Secretary and Chair, Chemical Engineering Graduate Student Advisory Council  
*Artie McFerrin Department of Chemical Engineering, Texas A&M University*  
Addressed graduate student welfare through communication and feedback loops with department administration.
- Apr 2014-  
Mar 2015 | Manager, Competitions, AZeotropy 2015  
*IIT Bombay's Intercollegiate Chemical Engineering Symposium*  
Pioneered a new model-making competition *ChemETimer* based on time-precision. Designed a presentation-based competition *Swaasthya* on engineering-applications to healthcare. Designed *Cipher*, the online cryptic hunt which received a participation of 400+. Actualized unconventional chemical engineering quizzing for *Chem-O-Philia*, national level quiz.

## Key Course Projects

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- Spring 2018 | Determining Diffusion Coefficient of Microparticles using Particle-Tracking Algorithms  
*Course: Colloidal Applications and Biomolecular Interactions in Life Science*  
Employed particle-tracking algorithms in MATLAB to track the Brownian diffusion of submicron-sized particles recorded using phase-contrast microscopy. Determined the diffusion coefficient of the particles by calculating the average mean-squared displacement of an ensemble.

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| Spring 2017 | <b>Project Proposal: Evolution of Bacterial Flagellum</b><br>Proposed a study involving the comparison of flagellar genome across multiple bacterial species which has potential to aid in obstruction of pathogenic motility. Carried out BLAST alignment analysis for nucleotide and protein sequences of flagellin (flagellar filament) gene as preliminary results. | <i>Course: Evolutionary Bioinformatics</i> |
| Spring 2016 | <b>Review: How Deep a Cell Can Sense</b><br>Carried out a literature survey and reported theoretical, in-vitro as well as in-silico studies on quantified investigations about the range of mechanical signaling.                                                                                                                                                       | <i>Course: Cell Mechanics</i>              |
| Fall 2015   | <b>Estimation of Concentrations in a Bio-Reactor</b><br>Generated true states from a model based on substrate uptake, phosphorus repression and effect of seed culture on glyco-peptide antibiotic production. Implemented the Simple, Extended and Unscented versions of Kalman Filter to estimate the concentrations.                                                 | <i>Course: State Estimation</i>            |

## COVID-19 Volunteering

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| 2020 | <b>Coronasurveys: Monitoring the Incidence of COVID-19 via Open Surveys</b><br>Volunteered services as the primary translator of the survey to the Gujarati language. |
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